

CONCAT Function in Excel

1. What is CONCAT?

The CONCAT function joins text, numbers, or cell values into one combined piece of text. It solves the problem of having related information in separate columns, such as a first name and a last name. A Data Analyst uses it to build full names, IDs, addresses, and labels from existing columns without retyping.

2. Syntax

=CONCAT(text1, [text2], ...)

Argument	Required?	What it accepts
text1	Required	Text in quotes, a number, a cell reference, or a range (for example A2 or A2:C2)
text2, ...	Optional	More text, numbers, cells, or ranges to join. Excel accepts up to 253 arguments.

CONCAT puts nothing between the items. To add a space or a symbol, type it as text in quotes, such as " " or "- ". Using a range, such as =CONCAT(A2:C2), joins every cell in that range one after another with no separator.

3. Simple Example

Combine first name and last name with a space:

	A	B	C
1	First Name	Last Name	Full Name
2	Rahim	Khan	Rahim Khan
3	Karim	Ali	Karim Ali
4	Hasan	Rana	Hasan Rana
5	Nabil	Hossain	Nabil Hossain

Formula in C2: =CONCAT(A2, " ", B2), then copied down to C5. For row 2, Excel takes the text in A2 ("Rahim"), adds the space from the quotes, then adds the text in B2 ("Khan"). **Result: Rahim Khan**

4. Another Example

Create an order ID from a region code and an order number:

	A	B	C
1	Region Code	Order No	Order ID
2	DHK	1001	DHK-1001
3	CTG	1002	CTG-1002
4	SYL	1003	SYL-1003
5	RAJ	1004	RAJ-1004

Formula in C2: =CONCAT(A2, "-", B2), then copied down to C5. Excel joins the code in A2, a hyphen, and the number in B2. The result is text, even though part of it came from a number. **Result: DHK-1001**

5. When to Use It

- Create full names from separate first name and last name columns
- Create IDs or codes by joining fields, such as region code and number
- Build addresses from street, city, and ZIP columns
- Create labels such as "Product - Category" for reports
- Create a unique key from two columns to use in lookups

6. Important Things to Remember

- CONCAT adds nothing between items by itself. Add spaces and symbols as text in quotes.
- Typed text must be in quotation marks. Cell references do not need quotes.
- The result is always text, even if you join numbers. It cannot be used directly in calculations as a number.
- Numbers are joined as stored: 1200 stays 1200, not 1,200. Dates appear as serial numbers, such as 46023.
- CONCAT accepts ranges such as A2:C2. The older CONCATENATE function does not.
- CONCAT is available in Excel 2019, Excel 2021, and Microsoft 365, but not in Excel 2016 or earlier.

7. Common Mistakes

Mistake: Forgetting the space, so "Rahim" and "Khan" become "RahimKhan". **Fix:** Add " " between the two cells.

Mistake: Forgetting quotation marks around typed text, such as =CONCAT(A2, -, B2). **Fix:** Write "-" in quotes.

Mistake: Joining a date and getting a number such as 46023. **Fix:** Convert the date to text first with the TEXT function, for example TEXT(A2, "dd-mmm-yyyy").

Mistake: Using a range such as =CONCAT(A2:C2) and expecting spaces between the items. **Fix:** Range joining adds no separators. List each cell and separator individually.

8. Data Analyst Tip

Use CONCAT to build a unique key when two columns together identify a record, for example =CONCAT(A2, "-", B2). This makes lookups and duplicate checks easier. If you need to keep the joined results after deleting the original columns, copy them and paste as values first.